Kai Yong Lai (Vandyck)

Tech Generalist

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About Me

Product engineer with strong emphasis on concepts & product understanding beyond tech stack. Experienced in multiple industries and multiple tech specializations with award-winning applications. Demonstrated leadership through community building.

Experience

Product Engineer @ *Gacha*

Aug 2025 — Current Remote | Hong Kong

- Lead a team of 4 to develop the mobile app from 0 to daily active users of 1000+, drive 90% purchases on app daily
- In charge of core modules like payment and business intelligence tracking & reporting

Product Engineer @ *RareSkills*

Jan 2025 — Aug 2026 Remote | United States

- Solely designed, developed and deployed end-to-end solution for code exercise platform as the only developer
- Worked closely with COO and CEO to design product features and business logic

Full Stack Software Developer @ *Farmz Asia*

Aug 2023 — Feb 2025 Remote | Singapore

- Led development of membership portal & beauty challenge module on mobile app reaching 2000+ users
- UX UI design and implementation of sleep ring hardware module and admin portal

Education

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering

Asia Pacific University | De Montfort University

Nov 2022 — Nov 2024 Kuala Lumpur, MY CGPA: 3.69/4.00

Ambassadorship

- MongoDB Champion: Face of MongoDB in Malaysia, spoke, mentored and judged in multiple events
- GDG Cloud KL Lead: Organized workshops, conferences, meetups (10k+ participants)
- Notion Ambassadors: Organized meetups in Malaysia, spoke in Notion events
- Stripe Community Builder: Spoke in Stripe events, organized workshops and meetups in Malaysia

Public Speaking & Judging

Google Developer Group Cloud KL DevFest 2026 - *RAG with MongoDB Atlas, Gemini, and Voyage AI*

MongoDB NYC AI Hackathon 2026 - *First round judge*

MongoDB .local London 2025 - *Livestream podcast on Community Upskilling*

AWS Cloud Day Malaysia 2024 - *Building RAG with MongoDB & Amazon Bedrock*

Technical Skills

Language	Python · TypeScript · JavaScript · Golang · Dart
Frontend	React · Angular · Vue · Next · Flutter
Backend	Django · Node · FastAPI · Gin · Laravel
AI/ML	Gemini · OpenAI · Anthropic · LangChain · RAG
Cloud	AWS · Azure · Firebase · Cloudflare, Posthog
Data	MongoDB · MySQL · PostgreSQL · S3 · RDS
Web3	Solidity · web3 · ethers · Move · Hardhat

Projects

Gacha Pull - TCG Collectibles E-Commerce Platform Built platform from product features to business analytics with crypto/fiat payment flow. *React Native, React, Hono, Posthog, Cloudflare, Supabase, EVM*

RareCode - LLM Guided Code Exercises Built and deployed AI-assisted learning platform with custom compiler (Rust, Solidity) backend using serverless architecture. *Next, AWS, Docker, MongoDB, Gemini*

Exponent AI - Web3 Research AI Agent Built multi-platform AI research agent for real-time crypto research. *Docker, Python, React, FireWorks AI, Discord.js, Ansible, Hasura*

Farmz Asia Mobile App - Wellness at your fingertip Led development of wellness tracking features with 2K+ downloads. *Flutter, Golang, Vultr, MySQL*

Consulting & Training

Led Atlassian team and consulted on Notion/Lark platforms - providing administration, custom development, training, and productivity tool migration

Certifications

- AWS Solution Architect Associate
- Microsoft Certified: DevOps Engineer Expert
- MongoDB Certified Associate Data Modeler
- Notion Advanced

Awards & Recognition

- MongoDB William Zola Award for Community Excellence 2026 Champion
- MongoDB User Group Leader of the Month January 2026
- ETH KL 2024 Main Track Winner (1st/60+ teams)
- Hilti ITC 2024 Champion (Trip to Switzerland)
- Google Workspace Hackathon Main Track Champion (1200 participants)
- BNB Hack Q4 Top 10 (200+ teams)
- Solana BuildStation Champion (200+ participants)

Languages

Professional: English, Mandarin, Malay | Conversational: Cantonese | Basic: Japanese

Referee

Harshit Mehta, Senior Developer Advocate @ MongoDB

harshit.mehta@live.com